majority of the physics community. He never returned to research, but he remained closely in touch with most all branches of physics, and served as a powerful foil off whom younger physicists could bounce their ideas, until his death from cancer in 1967.

John Wheeler, at age eighty-two, continues his quest to understand the marriage of quantum mechanics and general relativity—and continues to inspire younger generations with his lectures and writings, most notably his recent book *A Journey into Gravity and Spacetime* (Wheeler, 1990).

Roger Penrose, like Wheeler and many others, is obsessed with the marriage of general relativity and quantum mechanics and with the ill-understood laws of quantum gravity that should spring forth from that marriage. He has written about his unconventional ideas in a book for nonphysicists *(The Emperor's New Mind,* Penrose, 1989). Many physicists are skeptical of his views, but Penrose has been right so many times before . . .

Stephen Hawking also continues to be obsessed with the laws of quantum gravity, and most especially with the question of what those laws predict about the origin of the Universe. Like Penrose, he has written a book for nonphysicists, describing his ideas *(A Brief History of Time,* Hawking, 1988). His health holds strong, despite his ALS